



Right to have internet!

Finland is the first country in the world to make 1 Mbps broadband access a legal right to its 5.5 million citizens

How not to do stuff

Videojug.com, other than some seriously useful stuff, has some really funny videos in their humour section. Go check them out for a few laughs

The crux is that it allows you to perform certain tasks, much like your desktop applications but on a remote server, for instance Google Docs. In effect, you leverage the computing power and the software environment of the online or 'cloud' service. Data, software, computing power are all accessed from a cloud of online resources. Users can access these resources and their data from anywhere using just a browser. Therefore, it becomes a great tool to synchronise information, leaving you to not be restricted by the specific machine you normally use. You can start being productive from any PC with an internet connection. Your documents and other personalisations simply get loaded from the cloud. This kind of application support is known as SaaS (software as a service).

So what are the advantages? And where will cloud computing take us? The advantages are present - no version issues, and no upfront costs in software licensing, to name a few. Netbooks are only the first wave of devices that will eventually come out once cloud computing takes off in a big way. Devices will move towards being ultraportable, and highly stripped down near empty shells, with much of their computing taking place in the cloud. Many are looking at the cloud as a viable platform for an operating system

Cloud services aren't all about productivity either. The cloud can be about fun. Another service that is served up to you from the cloud is internet radio. With services such as last.fm or your music being streamed to your cell phone via cloud services such as Winamp remote, it is now becoming possible to leave the MP3 player at home and tune into the cloud. Cloud computing even allows hardware to be utilised remotely.

Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud, also known as "EC2", is a commercial web service that allows paying customers to rent computers on which to run their own computer



Illustration: Chaitanya Surpur

applications. Some people abroad have already begun downloading their torrents on these EC2 virtual comps and streaming them straight onto the screen. Sounds like a very nice picture right? Nope not quite. For people to start

fiasco have made it clear that it is not as reliable as we might think. The ubiquity of the internet is what has resulted in the feasibility of devices such as the SideKick, which store all user data on the cloud. Now, however, the illusion that



For more perils of cloud computing
www.thinkdigit.com/d/cloudy

depending on the cloud, certain infrastructure prerequisites need to catch up.

Connections have to become more stable, secure, and much faster. There is also the issue of server-side failure. That means answering the question of "what if the cloud disappears?". As the cloud becomes more lucrative as a destination for your data, instances such as the Twitter leak, the many Gmail outages, and now the T-Mobile

your data is safest in the cloud is lost. Last month T-Mobile SideKick customers had been facing a total outage, with no access to their data, with a lack of local storage this meant that a simple restart of the device would mean a total loss of all your private data.

Move over hard copies, Google Editions are here

Google has forever been trying

to get its finger in all pies. And last month's announcement that it will launch a new ebook store called Google Editions next year, only strengthens its position. The ebook market is currently dominated by Amazon and Barnes & Noble who sell ebooks that are tethered to devices such as Amazon's Kindle. Google Editions on the other hand will allow more number of soon-to-be-launched ebook readers to be compatible. In fact, any device with a browser can access these books. Initially, when Google rumours around this were circulating on the web, speculation was rampant that this will be a cloud based service. That means you don't own the book, but only the rights to it as long as you're able to access it. But fears were soon put to rest as Google recently clarified that users need only access a particular book once from their device of choice, and a copy is automatically cached for later use. This might spell huge trouble for Amazon and its Kindle.

Google Editions will be launched with a repertoire of about half a million titles sometime in the first half of 2010. Leveraging its superior search technology, Google will make the books fully indexed and searchable. So how would the endeavour work for Google? It will follow three modes of access. First, the books can be bought from Google directly in which case Google keeps 37 per cent of the amount, while the other 63 per cent goes to the publisher. The second route will allow customers to pick up the books from a partner retailer where the publisher gets to keep 45 per cent and the remaining 55 per cent is split between the online retailer and Google in some proportion. The third option is to purchase directly from the publisher's web site. No details are known yet about the last avenue.

All in all, there is going to be a lot of action in the ebooks segment in the coming months and we're quite keen to see which player emerges as the winner. Be it the multitude of device makers that are entering this sector or the content provider. **d**